Full Script — Director's Version

Chapter one of Ahmad Caver's story. We are not filming a basketball game. We are introducing Ahmad Caver through a basketball game.

What changed from the first draft

The first draft had the right structure and the right rule. These ten upgrades turn a solid plan into a film that holds attention and sets up a series.

1. **A cold open.** The film no longer starts with a bag and a pair of shoes. It starts with one sentence of Ahmad's about who he is, over an empty court, then jumps back to the start of the day. The first five seconds now sell the person, not the location.
2. **The conversation becomes the narration.** Beat 5 is recorded as the voice-over spine for the whole film. Arrival, pre-game and the game all play under his own words. That means we record the conversation with the edit in mind: full sentences, questions restated in the answer, specific stories.
3. **A hard cap on the game.** Ninety seconds, with one signature moment treated as the peak: sound pulled out, slow motion, crowd slammed back in. Everything else is support.
4. **A change of location for Meet Ahmad.** Basketball lives in the arena. The person lives somewhere else. The conversation moves to a second location (car, late-night Ramat Gan, his apartment) so the environment does the storytelling for us.
5. **Rituals instead of generic details.** We ask Ahmad before the shoot for two or three real game-day habits. A specific ritual beats a generic headphones shot every time.
6. **Natural sound as the hero.** Sneakers, ball on hardwood, the net, the bench, the crowd. Music sits under it and never on top.
7. **A win-or-lose plan.** The story works either way. Post-game questions and the ending line adapt on the night.
8. **Time-stamped chapter cards.** Small on-screen times (16:30, 18:45, 20:00, 22:40) give the vlog a clock and forward motion without a narrator.
9. **A Chapter One ending.** His closing line, then a card that reads Chapter One. The audience learns it is a series before we ever say so.
10. **The Reel is planned, not reframed.** Vertical shots are captured on the day with a phone, and the Reel opens with a three-second hook in his voice.

Core idea, feel and the voice rule

Core idea. A short cinematic game-day story that introduces Ahmad through basketball first, then lets people meet the person behind the player.

Feel. Natural, cinematic, personal, confident. Handheld but steady. Long lenses from a distance in the arena, close and warm in the conversation. Not over-produced. Not a generic highlight video.

The voice rule. Ahmad is the only voice in the film. No narrator, no interviewer heard on camera, no text that explains what we are looking at. If a moment needs explaining, we did not shoot it right, or we let his voice-over carry it.

What we never do.

- No re-staged moments. If we missed it, we missed it.
- No stock transitions, no speed ramps on every cut, no trending-audio edits in the YouTube film.
- No questions he has to think about for the first time on camera. He gets the topics in advance, never the lines.
- No shots that make him look small: no extreme high angles, no fisheye, no filming up his nose from a gimbal.

Target. YouTube film 4 to 7 minutes, ideal 5:30. Instagram Reel 30 to 60 seconds, ideal 45.

Audience. Three at once: Israeli fans who know the league, his US following who know him from before, and agents and clubs who will watch this when his name comes up. The film is spoken in English. Hebrew subtitles go on the Reel and are offered as a caption track on YouTube. Beat 3 keeps one defensive possession and one playmaking moment for the third audience; beat 5 keeps the character for the first two.

Ahmad's energy. First shoot together, and he is not a high-energy talker. We do not fight that, we build the film on it. The tone is quiet confidence: fewer lines to camera, more observation, long holds on his face, and a conversation shot in motion (the car first, a walk second) where he has somewhere to look and something to do with his hands. We never ask him to "bring energy." Calm on camera reads as control.

Beat 0 — Cold open (0:00 to 0:10)

Goal. Make the viewer care about the person before they see a basketball.

Picture. Black. Then the empty court with the house lights half down, shot from court level after the game, or Ahmad alone on the bench with the arena emptying behind him. Slow, static, wide. We have the court after the final buzzer and nothing beyond it, so this is the last thing we shoot and the first thing people see.

Sound. Room tone, a distant ball bounce or a mop on hardwood. Then his voice, lifted from the beat 5 conversation. Direction for the line we are hunting:

> "People see the player. They don't really know..." or "I'm Ahmad Caver. Most people know me for one thing..."

We do not script the line. We ask the question in beat 5 in a way that gets us a sentence like this, and we pick the best one in the edit.

Card. AHMAD CAVER, then a beat, then CHAPTER ONE. Small, clean, lower third or centered, white on the image. No logo yet.

Cut. Hard cut to daylight and movement: beat 1. A small time-stamp card reads the arrival time.

Beat 1 — Arrival (0:10 to 0:50)

Goal. Pull the viewer into Ahmad's day immediately. Movement, daylight, purpose.

Capture.

- The approach, outside the arena: car door, the walk across the parking lot, the building growing in frame. Long lens from far away, then close on the gimbal.
- Details in passing, never lingered on: shoes, bag strap, headphones going on, keys, the phone going into the pocket.
- Natural interactions at the entrance: security, a staff member, a teammate arriving at the same time. We stay wide and let it happen.
- The first look at the court, from behind his shoulder as he walks in from the entrance. This is the shot that ends the beat.
- One or two quick lines to camera on the walk, handheld, close, lav hidden under the collar.

The one question. "What's the mindset going into tonight?" Follow-up only if the first answer is one word: "Where does that come from?"

Sound. His footsteps, the door, the hum of the arena from inside. Music starts here, low, a pulse rather than a melody.

Voice-over from beat 5. Lines about where he is from and how long basketball has been in his life sit well here. The walk in is the journey; his words tell us how long it has been.

Edit note. Keep it under 40 seconds. If arrival runs long, people leave before they meet him.

Beat 2 — Pre-game (0:50 to 2:00)

Goal. Build anticipation. The energy rises from quiet to loud, from alone to together, from still to moving.

Capture, in the order the energy builds.

1. His rituals on the court. We know them in advance from him and we are in position before they happen. We have no locker room and no tunnel, so everything in this beat lives on the floor and the bench.
2. Stepping onto the court for the first time. Wide from the far baseline, then low as he crosses the line.
3. Stretching and activation with the strength coach. Close on hands, feet, breath.
4. The shooting routine. This is the cinematic centerpiece of the beat: same spot, repeated form, the net sound. Three angles from one camera, one after the other: behind the basket, baseline low, and from the free-throw line extended. Let the edit find the rhythm.
5. Teammate interactions: handshakes, jokes, the huddle. Long lens from the far side, we are not in the circle.
6. The quiet focused moment on the bench before tip-off: eyes closed, headphones, a look up at the stands, the anthem if there is one. Hold this shot longer than feels comfortable. Then we leave the floor for the gallery.
7. Wide shot of the arena filling, from the gallery, once we are up there.

Sound. Natural sound rises: more balls, more voices, the PA, the crowd. Music builds with it and drops out completely on the quiet moment in step 7.

Voice-over from beat 5. What keeps him hungry. What he still loves about the game. These lines over the shooting routine turn repetition into character.

Edit note. End the beat on silence and a look, then cut to the loudest thing we have: the tip-off.

Beat 3 — The game (2:00 to 3:30)

Goal. Show Ahmad as the athlete. Make the viewer feel the game, not watch it.

Position. From the gallery, standing with the crowd. This is a feature, not a limit: the high angle reads the play like a coach's tape, and the fans in the foreground are the atmosphere we would otherwise have to go looking for. Pick a spot before tip-off: first row of the gallery, near the half-court line, with a clean line to both baskets. Long lens on a monopod, 50 or 60 fps, follow him and not the ball.

Capture.

- Tip-off, wide, the whole floor in frame. One shot, then tight.
- Best plays on the long lens: drives, finishes, assists, pull-ups. Follow him, not the ball. Let the play leave the frame rather than whip-panning after it.
- Defense. A stop, a deflection, a stance. The high angle shows positioning better than any courtside camera.
- Reactions after plays: stay on him for two seconds after the play ends. From the gallery his reactions are small in frame, so the tight lens matters.
- Bench moments on the long lens: the towel, the water, the coach talking, the look at the scoreboard.
- Crowd and atmosphere, shot from inside the crowd: hands in the foreground, faces beside us, the noise. Cut-aways we will need, and the easiest shots of the night from where we are.
- Scoreboard and clock, several through the game.
- Emotional moments: a foul call, a big three, a timeout huddle, the final seconds.

The signature moment. One play, chosen in the edit, gets the full treatment: the sound drops to nothing on the gather, the shot plays at 40 percent speed, and the crowd slams back in on the make or the reaction. This is the peak of the whole film. Everything before it builds to it, everything after it comes down from it.

Sound. Natural arena sound carries the beat. Music returns only under the montage of plays and leaves for the signature moment.

Voice-over from beat 5. Very little. One line at most, right before the signature moment, something about what he feels when the game slows down for him.

Edit note. Ninety seconds, hard cap. The game is the peak of the story, not the story. If we have ten great plays, we use four.

Beat 4 — After the game (3:30 to 4:10)

Goal. The turn from basketball player to person. The adrenaline is still in him and the audience should feel it.

Where and when. On the court or at the bench, within five minutes of the final buzzer, before he heads to the locker room. We get the court back after the game, and that is all we get: no tunnel, no hallway. We come down from the gallery during the final minute so we are on the floor when the horn goes. Handheld, close, one camera, lav clipped on as we say hello. No lights.

How. Let him react first. No question for the first twenty seconds. If he says nothing, the silence and the breathing are the shot. Then three questions, in this order:

1. "How did that one feel?"
2. "What stood out to you tonight?"
3. "What's the mindset after a game like this?"

Rules. Answers stay short and natural. We do not ask him to repeat. We do not ask him to say the score. If he swears, we keep it or bleep it in the edit, we do not stop him.

Sound. Natural only. The crowd leaving, the PA, teammates and staff in the background. No music until the last answer, where the music for beat 5 fades in under his final words and carries us to the new location.

Edit note. This is the hinge of the film. The last line of this beat should be about him, not about the game, and it should feel like the start of a different conversation.

Beat 5 — Meet Ahmad (4:10 to 5:40)

Goal. Give viewers a reason to follow him beyond tonight. This is also the narration source for the whole film, so it is the most important forty minutes of the shoot.

Setting. A different place and a different pace. Our recommendation for Ahmad, who is not a big talker on camera: the car ride home. A car gives him somewhere to look, something to do with his hands, and no eye-contact pressure, and people say more when they are moving. One camera on a window or dash mount facing him, a phone on the passenger side as the second angle. Second choice: a walk through his neighborhood at night, camera on the gimbal walking beside him. Third: his place, on the couch with the lights low. Interviewer sits beside him and is never heard in the final film.

How we run it. It is a conversation, not an interview. We talk for a few minutes with nothing rolling. Then we roll and never stop. He gets the topics in advance, never the questions word for word. Two asks of him before we start: answer in full sentences, and put the question inside the answer ("I'm from…" instead of "Atlanta."). This is what makes the lines usable over the pictures.

The conversation, topic by topic. The follow-ups in brackets are what gets us the real answer.

Topic	Opening question	Follow-up	Where the answer goes in the film
Who he is	"If someone has never seen you play, how do you introduce yourself?"	"And what do they not see?"	Cold open

Topic	Opening question	Follow-up	Where the answer goes in the film
Where he is from	"Where is home, and what did it give you?"	"What does your family see when they watch you now?"	Arrival
The game in his life	"How long has basketball been part of your life? What's the first memory?"	"Who put the ball in your hands?"	Arrival, pre-game
What keeps him hungry	"You've been doing this a long time. What still gets you up for it?"	"Was there a moment you almost stopped?"	Pre-game, shooting routine
What he still enjoys	"What do you still love about the game, the part that never got old?"	"Describe the feeling when it slows down for you."	The signature moment
Game day from the inside	"Walk me through a game day. What does 4pm feel like?"	"What's the one thing you have to do before you go out?"	Time-stamp cards, rituals
Life off the court	"When you're not here, where are you and what are you doing?"	"What would surprise people?"	Meet Ahmad
The side he wants seen	"What side of you do you want people to see this season?"	"Why now?"	Meet Ahmad
Israel and Ramat Gan	"What's it like living and playing here?"	"What's a place here that feels like yours?"	Meet Ahmad
What is coming	"What can people expect from you this season, on and off the court?"	"Say it to them, not to me."	Ending

Rules. One question at a time. Let silence sit; the second answer is usually the better one. Never move on while he is still thinking. Ask "why" and "give me an example" more than anything else. If a story starts, follow it even if it is not on the list.

Sound. Lav plus boom. Room tone recorded for a full minute before and after. If we are in the car, we record with the engine running and once with it off.

Edit note. In the final film this beat is a minute and a half of him talking on camera, mixed with B-roll of the location and quiet details. The rest of what we record lives over beats 0 to 3 as voice-over.

Beat 6 — Next chapter (5:40 to 6:00)

Goal. Create continuation. The viewer should finish knowing there is more, and wanting it.

The line. One sentence from Ahmad that promises more, in his words. Direction, not script:

> "This is only the beginning. You'll see a lot more this season."

We get it from the last question of beat 5, said to the audience rather than to us. We ask for two or three versions, each shorter than the last.

Picture. Final cinematic shots: the arena lights going down, the empty court, the exit corridor, Ahmad walking away from camera through the doors into the night. The last frame is wide and still.

Cards.

1. CHAPTER ONE, small, centered.
2. EA Visuals × Ahmad Caver.
3. Nothing else. No "subscribe," no "follow," no end-screen clutter inside the picture. YouTube end-screen elements go outside the frame in the last 20 seconds.

Sound. Music resolves on the walk-out. The last sound in the film is his footsteps or a door closing, not a music hit.

Edit note. Total runtime lands at 5:30 to 6:00. If the cut runs long, the game loses time first, never the conversation.

Win or lose

The film is about Ahmad, not the result, so the structure does not change. Three things do.

Night	Beat 4 questions	Signature moment	Ending line direction
Win, big night	"How did that one feel?" "What stood out?" "What's the mindset after a night like this?"	His best play, full treatment	"This is only the beginning."

Night	Beat 4 questions	Signature moment	Ending line direction
Win, quiet night for him	"How did that one feel?" "What did the team need from you tonight?"	A defensive stop or an assist, framed as the team's moment	"Every night asks something different. You'll see all of it."
Loss	Twenty seconds of silence first. Then: "What are you taking from tonight?" "What's the mindset after a game like this?"	One moment of effort, not a highlight: a dive, a stop, a word to a teammate	"This is one night. There's a whole season coming."
Limited minutes or injury	Beat 3 shrinks to 45 seconds and leans on bench and crowd. Beat 5 grows.	A bench reaction or a huddle	Same as above; the honesty is the content

Rule for the crew. We never change our energy with the result. Same distance, same quiet, same respect. On a loss we give him more space and ask less.

Instagram Reel (45 seconds)

A fast cinematic version of the same story, built from the same footage plus the vertical captures from the day. Shot vertically where possible, reframed only where we must.

Time	Section	Picture	Sound
0:00 to 0:03	Hook	Tight on his face on the bench before tip-off, or the signature moment at 40 percent speed	One line in his voice: the cold-open sentence. On-screen caption of the same words, Hebrew and English
0:03 to 0:10	Arrival	Four quick shots: car door, walk, shoes, first look at the court	Music in, footsteps on top
0:10 to 0:20	Preparation	Shooting routine from three angles, the quiet moment, the huddle	Net sound in rhythm with the music
0:20 to 0:32	Best moments	Three or four plays from the gallery, the signature moment, the reaction	Crowd up, music drops for the signature moment, slams back

Time	Section	Picture	Sound
0:32 to 0:41	Ahmad	Conversation footage from the car, warm and close, intercut with night streets	His voice: the line about what people don't see, or what keeps him hungry
0:41 to 0:45	Closing	Walk away across the empty court, cut to black	His closing line, then the card: Chapter One. EA Visuals × Ahmad Caver

Rules. Captions on every spoken line, clean sans-serif, no emoji. Cut on the beat but not on every beat. Cover image is the hook frame. The caption copy under the Reel points to the full film on YouTube.

Teaser (10 to 15 seconds). The signature moment at full slow motion, his cold-open line, the card. Posted the day before the film.

Sound, music, text and color

Sound. Natural sound is the hero: sneakers, ball on hardwood, net, bench, crowd. Record room tone at every location. Lav on Ahmad whenever he is in street clothes. Nothing from a sound library pretending to be the arena.

Music. Two tracks at most. One pulse for the day, one warmer piece for the conversation and the ending. Licensed. Music never sits on top of his voice; it ducks under every spoken line. It leaves entirely for the quiet pre-game moment and the signature play.

Voice-over. Ahmad only. Lines are lifted from beat 5 and placed where the table in beat 5 says. No line is used over the picture it describes literally; his words about home play over the walk in, not over a map.

Text. Three kinds and no more: the opening cards, the time-stamp chapter cards, the closing cards. One clean typeface, white, small, lower third or centered. No lower-third name tags, no stat graphics, no captions in the YouTube film. Captions only on the Reel.

Color. Natural and warm. Skin tones first. The arena stays a little cool and the conversation location warm, so the cut between them feels like a change of world. No heavy teal-and-orange, no crushed blacks, no film-grain overlay.

Frame rate and format. 24 or 25 fps for the film, 50 or 60 fps for the game and the shooting routine. 16:9 for YouTube, 9:16 for the Reel and teaser, captured natively where possible.